MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: Wednesday, March 4, 2020. **TIME: 2hrs.**

Instruction: Answer **all** questions. **2-4 pm**

QUESTION 1

A. In any communication, you are likely to find the following elements: **source, message, channel, receiver, feedback and noise**. Briefly explain each one of them. **(6 marks)**

B. Imagine that classes are suspended at Mzuzu University (Mzuni) due to a sit-in by both academic and non-academic staff members who are seeking for a salary increment. The sit-in has lasted two weeks and it promises to drag on because government is non-committal in addressing their concerns. The management is also mum on whether the university will be closed officially to relieve students of the financial burden.

As the president of the Mzuni Students Representative Council, you have been tasked to engage university management to address the plight of students while they find a lasting solution to the staff's grievances.

Questions

i. What type of verbal communication would you use to express your concerns with the management? **(1 mark)**

ii. Justify your answer in B (i) above with **four** reasons. **(8 marks)**

C. i. What is a theory? **(1 mark)**

ii. The Mathematical Theory of Communication asserts that communication is largely linear and sequential phenomenon in which information is sent from 'senders' to 'receivers' through particular channels. This theory received a lot of criticism that prompted other scholars to come up with different theories. Explain how you think the communication process takes place without repeating the one stated here. **(4 marks)**

QUESTION 2

A. When using the APA style of referencing one needs to use citations and create a reference list. Briefly explain the difference between the two? **(4 marks)**

B. Study the information below and compile it into entries as they would appear in a reference list:

i. John Patrick Banda and James Phiri, Dzuka Publishers; Blantyre. The Legend in making, 2010. **(5marks)**

ii. Gaba's goal nominated, The Daily Times, p.43. Mabvuto Kambuwe. 10 February, 2020. **(5marks)**

C. Explain briefly **two** instances where one uses:

i. **Direct quotations** during citation **(3 marks)**

ii. ***Et al*** during citation **(3 marks)**

QUESTION 3

A. Explain the following as they relate to listening;

i. Listening with more than your ears **(1mark)**

ii. Holding ones fire **(1mark)**

iii. Being an active listener **(1mark)**

B. Abraham Maslow's **theory of needs** contends that people are driven by needs to act as they do and that the needs ought to be satisfied for one's life to be complete.

i. State the **five** levels of this theory. **(5marks)**

ii. With the aid of an example in each case, show how the first four levels relate to you as a student. **(12 marks)**

END OF QUESTION PAPER